

Right before בני ישראל commanded to turn back so that פרעה would think they were wandering aimlessly. The pasuk says (14:2): וַיָּשָׁבוּ וַיֵּהָנוּ לִפְנֵי פִי הַקְּהִירָה. As we know, there are four different methods of explaining a dvar torah, represented by the acronym פרדס: פשט, דרש, רמז, and סוד. פשט is the פשוט פשט, and רמז is a hint.

The Apter Rav, R' Avraham Yehoshua Heshel זצ"ל, also known as the אוהב ישראל, uses this pasuk as a רמז to a beautiful מידה that a person would be wise to adopt throughout life: וַיָּשָׁבוּ וַיֵּהָנוּ. לִפְנֵי פִי הַקְּהִירָה. פִי means "mouth," and קִירָה can be understood as "freedom" or "letting loose." The Apter Rav explains that before allowing one's mouth the freedom to speak freely, a person should first וַיָּשָׁבוּ וַיֵּהָנוּ - pause and think carefully. Reflect on what you are about to say, weigh your words, and only then speak thoughtfully. This corresponds to the pasuk in משלי (21:23): שֹׁמֵר לִפְתָּחוֹ וּלְשׁוֹנוֹ - one who guards his mouth and tongue; שֹׁמֵר מִצָּרוֹת נַפְשׁוֹ - protects himself from trouble. A good idea.

